

ELEMENTARY RECESS WEATHER GUIDELINES

Recess shall be scheduled outdoors whenever possible. When weather conditions are questionable, principals shall refer to the following guidelines to determine the appropriateness of outdoor recess.

A. Temperature. Cold weather injuries such as hypothermia and frostbite and heat-related injuries such as dehydration, heat exhaustion, or heat stroke can be minimized or prevented by following these precautions. Please remember that young children are more sensitive to hot or cold temperatures. When in doubt, the building principal will make the final determination for students to participate in an outdoor activity.

B. Heat Index. The heat index is a number that combines air temperature and relative humidity in an attempt to determine the human-perceived equivalent temperature (what the temperature feels like outside).

1. If the heat index is less than 95 degrees, proceed with intense to moderate activities and monitor students carefully.

2. If the heat index is between 95-99 degrees, proceed with moderate to light activities; provide water breaks every 30 minutes; and, continue to monitor students carefully. Re-check heat index hourly.

3. If the heat index is greater than 100 degrees, no outdoor activities are permitted.

4. Be sure that students always have opportunities to hydrate themselves during and after activities. Water should never be withheld if requested by a student when exercising.

C. Wind Chill. Wind chill is a number that combines air temperature and wind in an attempt to determine the human-perceived equivalent temperature (what the temperature feels like outside).

1. If the windchill is between 32 and 39 degrees, students should have appropriate outdoor attire to stay warm and dry during recess.

2. If the wind chill is below 32 degrees, refrain from outdoor activities.

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D. Air Quality. The air quality is a measure of the composition of air with respect to quantities of pollutants.

1. CODE RED: Refrain from all outdoor activities.
2. CODE ORANGE: Students with respiratory diseases and asthma must refrain from all outdoor activities; participation for all other students is at the discretion of the principal.

E. Lightning. If lightning and/or thunder can be seen or heard, STOP the activity and have all staff and students return inside the school. Allow 30 minutes to pass after the last occurrence of lightning and/or thunder before resuming an activity outdoors.

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